# FormulaLab

*Excel practice, the way analysts actually learn it.*

**Stage** Prototype built · Phase 1 validation
**Market** India · Finance-track grads · FP&A, GCC, Big 4, IB-India
**Contact** Ruparelbrij@gmail.com

# You can’t watch your way through an Excel interview.

The interviewer says *“open a blank sheet and build a DCF.”* Every finance grad in India has watched Excel tutorials. Very few can do that.

# Everyone learns Excel wrong.

*The gap between how it's taught and how it's tested.*

### WHAT STUDENTS ACTUALLY DO

- Watch a 40-minute VLOOKUP tutorial on YouTube.
- Download a finished DCF template as reference.
- Skim the formulas and feel confident.
- Never write a single formula from scratch.

### WHAT INTERVIEWS ACTUALLY TEST

- "Open a blank workbook and build a 3-statement model."
- Write formulas from memory, under time pressure.
- Debug when something breaks.
- Explain your choices out loud.

# Reps, *not replays.*

You don’t get good at Excel by watching it. You get good the way you get good at any craft — by doing it, being told exactly what’s wrong, and doing it again.

# A working spreadsheet, in the browser.

D5 | *fx* | `= ROUND(B4/B2*100, 1)`

| | A | B |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Dollars in millions | FY 2023 |
| 2 | Total revenues | 96,773 |
| 3 | Total cost of revenues | 79,113 |
| 4 | Gross profit | 17,660 |
| 5 | **Gross margin %** | **18.2%** |

*Live cell — user types the formula, engine evaluates, answer is checked instantly.*

## 01 Real formula engine

45+ functions — SUM, VLOOKUP, XLOOKUP, SUMIFS, IF, INDEX/MATCH. Range refs, absolute/relative shifting, point-mode formula editing, fill handle. Not a mockup — a working spreadsheet.

## 02 Answer checking that isn't fooled

Verifies the value AND that the intended function was used. Typing "17,660" into the cell fails. Writing a VLOOKUP that returns the right value passes.

## 03 Real data, real tasks

Tesla FY 2023 10-K, Indian company filings, FP&A-style tasks. Interview-shaped exercises, not "add these numbers."

# A large, sharp, underserved pool.

*Not “everyone with a laptop” — a specific niche of motivated buyers.*

## Millions

Commerce & finance grads produced in India each year.

## GCCs

Global capability centres of JPM, Goldman, Big 4 hiring analysts at scale in India.

## Underserved

No India-focused hands-on Excel practice product at a student-affordable price today.

*Figures directional — replace with sourced TAM/SAM/SOM before any capital raise.*

# The honest table.

*Someone’s already here. We’re not pretending otherwise.*

| PLAYER | FORMAT | LIVE PRACTICE | INDIA-SPECIFIC | BEYOND IB |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| YouTube / Udemy | Video | No | *Some* | **Yes** |
| WSMojo / CFI | Video + templates | No | *CFI now targets India w/ pricing* | *Partial* |
| Quantus (US) | Interactive sheet | **Yes** | No | IB-heavy |
| **FormulaLab** | **Interactive sheet** | **Yes** | **Yes** | **FP&A + analyst craft** |

*CFI is now popping an India-specific FMVA pricing modal on Indian IPs — the "prestige certificate" ground is contested. We beat them on hands-on practice, not certificate design.*

# Where we win.

*Three positions Quantus and CFI won't take from us on day one.*

01

## Made for India

Indian listed companies. INR, Ind AS. Prep framed around Big 4, GCC, and Indian IB / FP&A recruiting — not US IB.

02

## Beyond banking

Most India finance jobs need Excel craft — lookups, pivots, dashboards, reporting — not just LBOs. We serve the majority, not only IB.

03

## Priced for students

CFI's FMVA is ~₹41,000. Our certificate is ₹499–999. Student-friendly freemium is the opening US players won't chase soon.

# The prototype is built, not vaporware.

**45+**

Excel functions implemented from scratch. Real tokenizer, parser, evaluator. Not a wrapper.

**22**

Hands-on graded exercises live across two courses.

**2**

Complete courses: Excel Formula Fundamentals, Financial Statements (real Tesla FY23 data).

**0**

External JavaScript libraries. Formula engine is 100% our code — portable to any front end.

Try it: excel-practice.html · single-file build, no dependencies, open in any browser.

# Cheap, then earned, then scaled.

*The plan is deliberately lean. Big spend only unlocks after demand is proven.*

**PHASE 1** Month 0-2 · Validate

## 5 free interactive exercises

Working demo with a free spreadsheet engine (already built). Post to Indian finance-prep communities. Measure completion, demand, willingness to pay before building anything heavy.

**₹3,000-8,000 total**

**PHASE 2** Month 2-6 · Build

## Real product, accounts, payments

Only if Phase 1 converts. Expand the exercise library. Google auth, per-user progress, paid tier. Self-build keeps cost low.

**₹5-10K/mo self-build · or ₹1.5-6L dev MVP**

**PHASE 3** Ongoing · Grow

## Organic-first growth + college pilots

Shareable free challenges as the marketing engine. SEO on interview questions. Placement-cell tie-ups. Paid ads only after the product already converts.

**₹0 ad spend · scale from revenue**

# Three revenue channels — in order.

*Sequenced by realism, not ambition. B2C validates, B2B scales.*

CHANNEL 1 · VALIDATION

## Certifications

**₹499 — 999**

one-time, per course

Concrete outcome that goes on a LinkedIn profile. Proven Indian edtech model (CFI's entire business). Simplest possible revenue mechanic — sell one before we build a subscription.

CHANNEL 2 · RETENTION

## Subscription

**₹399 / mo**

₹2,499 / year

Full library + interview bank + cross-device progress. Assume 1–3% conversion — Indian B2C edtech benchmark. Complements Channel 1, doesn't replace it.

CHANNEL 3 · SCALE

## College licensing

**₹100 — 300**

per student, per semester

Where Indian edtech actually makes money. Tier-2 / tier-3 colleges first — CFI is out of reach for them. 10 colleges × 500 students ≈ ₹20L ARR from one channel.

# The real revenue is B2B.

*Directional unit economics. Refine with pilot data before raising money.*

LTV PER USER, BY CHANNEL (₹)




Illustrative — Year 2

## 10 colleges

× 500 students each

× ₹200 per semester

---

= ₹10L per semester

## ≈ ₹20L ARR

*from a single channel, on realistic per-seat pricing.*

# What could kill it — and how we handle it.

| Risk | The scenario | Our mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| R01 **Low Indian B2C willingness to pay** | Freemium conversion in India is typically 1–3%. If revenue depends on subscription alone, the business starves. | Lead with ₹499 certificates — concrete outcome. Real revenue comes from college licensing, not consumer subscription. |
| R02 **CFI targeting India** | CFI now shows India-specific FMVA pricing on Indian IPs. The prestige-certificate ground is contested. | Do not compete on certificate design. Beat them on hands-on practice — which they still don't do — and on price by an order of magnitude. |
| R03 **Build burden vs free alternatives** | Real Excel, YouTube, and Copilot are free. Users can already "just practice in Excel yourself." | The graded-instant-feedback loop is the differentiator. Formula engine is already built — zero incremental engine cost per exercise. |

# Prove demand before we spend.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **Build 5 India-flavoured exercises** | One Indian listed company, INR, an FP&A-style task. Frame as a challenge people want to beat. |
| 02 | **Post to 3–4 finance communities** | LinkedIn analyst prep groups, Telegram CA / CFA / MBA finance groups. “Can you pass this Indian FP&A test?” |
| 03 | **Measure and decide** | Completions, requests for more, willingness to pay a ₹499 certificate. Then Phase 2 unlocks — or it doesn’t. |

Brij Ruparel · Ruparelbrij@gmail.com